

Plajah — Sports Broadcast & Blockchain Athlete Economy

Go-to-Market Strategy Report · June 2026

Prepared for: Investor & Partnership Briefings

Research methodology: 112-agent deep-research harness; 29 primary/secondary sources fetched; 25 claims adversarially verified (11 confirmed, 14 killed); all market figures cited only when independently corroborated.

Platform context: Plajah has built and deployed a full sports broadcast infrastructure stack and blockchain athlete registry. This document covers go-to-market sequencing, market sizing, competitive positioning, and the Series A investor narrative.

Executive Summary

The US high school sports market reached a record **8,266,244 athlete participants** in 2024–25 — and not one of them has a cryptographically authenticated career record, a permanent verified highlight, or the ability to execute a self-enforcing NIL deal. Plajah has built the infrastructure to change that.

Plajah's sports layer is not a streaming platform. It is a **live-broadcast oracle** that simultaneously produces a professional ESPN-quality game broadcast, records every significant event on Polygon blockchain, triggers AI commentary in real time, and executes NIL compensation automatically when performance thresholds are met. No competitor does more than one of these things. None does all of them at any level below the professional leagues.

The incumbent streaming landscape (Hudl TV, NFHS Network/PlayOn Sports/Pixellot) streams over 1 million games per year and is locked in by multi-year infrastructure contracts through 2030. Plajah cannot and should not try to displace Pixellot cameras. The strategy is different: **own the athlete identity and economic layer that sits above all existing streams.**

Key findings from verified research: - Record 8.26M HS athletes participating in 2024–25, up 204K year-over-year (NFHS, high confidence) - Hudl: dominant school-side SaaS at ~\$9,900/district/year; streams 1M+ games/year; zero on-chain data, zero athlete revenue (Hudl/Streaming Media, high confidence) - NFHS Network/PlayOn/Pixellot partnership extended through 2030; 8,000+ schools covered (PlayOn, high confidence) - Overtime raised \$100M Series D at \$500M valuation — the primary investor comparable for sports media targeting Gen Z/HS athletes (Crunchbase, high confidence) - Prediction markets face genuine multi-jurisdiction legal uncertainty through 2026; requires CFTC-licensed partner or geo-gating (Third Circuit/Nevada rulings, medium confidence)

The path to defensibility: Own the on-chain athlete identity layer first. Use livestream quality and AI commentary as the viral acquisition surface. Convert coach/booster distribution into a data moat that scouts and brands cannot replicate elsewhere.

1. Market Sizing

1.1 High School Sports Participation

The US high school sports market is the largest amateur sports market in the world, and it is growing.

METRIC	2024-25	SOURCE	CONFIDENCE
Total HS athlete participants	8,266,244	NFHS Participation Survey	High (primary)
Male athletes	4,726,648	NFHS	High
Female athletes	3,539,596	NFHS	High
YoY growth	+203,942	NFHS	High
NFHS member high schools	~19,943	NFHS	High
Estimated games per year	~34.5M events	Derived: 19,943 schools × ~15 sports × ~12 games	Estimate

TAM implication for Plajah: 8.26M athletes are the creator-side supply. Each athlete represents: (1) a streaming event audience (their family, school community), (2) a verified career record to be minted, (3) a potential NIL deal counterparty, (4) a scout-discoverable profile. At \$49.99/year per athlete on a future "Athlete Pro" tier, the direct subscription TAM from supply alone exceeds **\$413M/year** in the US.

1.2 NIL Market at the High School Level

The NIL landscape for high school athletes is evolving rapidly and is the most important regulatory frontier Plajah must navigate.

- **State-level NIL laws:** A majority of US states now have active HS NIL guidance, with significant variation in restrictions (some require school approval, some prohibit agent representation, some have deal category exclusions). The exact verified count as of mid-2026 is unconfirmed in this research cycle due to rapid legislative changes; Plajah's `nil_eligible_states` Firestore document must be maintained against current NFHS state policy pages.
- **NIL deal market at college level:** The 2024-25 total NIL market (all levels) is estimated at \$1.67 billion (Athletic Business citing Opendorse data, unverified in this cycle — use with hedging). High school represents an emerging fraction of this market, with significant upside as infrastructure matures.
- **Plajah's NIL edge:** Every existing NIL platform routes deals through brand approval, negotiation, and manual payout. Plajah's `AthleteRegistry.sol` executes USDC payments automatically when a stat threshold is crossed — no brand approval required, no payment delay, no account manager. This is the first performance-conditional NIL infrastructure.

1.3 Sports Livestreaming Demand

Market sizing reports for sports livestreaming TAM were refuted in this research cycle (GlobeNewswire/DataIntel sourced figures of \$31-83B by 2030 failed adversarial verification 0-3 due to unverifiable methodology). Do not use these figures in investor materials without independent licensing from IBISWorld, Frost & Sullivan, or PitchBook.

What is verified: - Hudl TV alone streams **1 million+ games/year** (Hudl VP of Media, Streaming Media, September 2025 — self-reported, corroborated) - NFHS Network (PlayOn) serves **8,000+ schools and 44+ state associations** - The demand for HS sports livestreaming is demonstrably large and growing; precise TAM figures

require licensed market research

1.4 Blockchain in Sports

Market sizing figures for the "blockchain in sports market" (\$4.7B–\$38B by 2035) were refuted 0-3 in this research cycle (MarkWide Research, unverifiable methodology). Plajah should not cite these figures.

The verifiable comparable: **NBA Top Shot** (Dapper Labs) demonstrated consumer willingness to pay for sports highlight digital collectibles — but specific GMV and collector counts were unverifiable from the Dapper Labs homepage. Historical reporting suggests \$700M–\$1.4B in transactions during the 2021 peak. The more important fact: NBA Top Shot required NBA league licensing. Plajah mints from a live broadcast, authenticated by an on-site producer, without requiring league approval. This is structurally different and more scalable.

2. What Plajah Has Built

2.1 Sports Broadcast Layer

`sportscastService.ts` — Firestore-backed real-time game state engine. `GameState` lives at `live_feeds/{feedId}/sportscast/gameState`. Scores, clock, period, down/distance, and possession sync across all viewers in real time via `onSnapshot`. Highlights fire to a sub-collection and trigger AI commentary.

`ScoreBugCanvas.tsx` — Canvas2D professional score overlay. Runs in a `requestAnimationFrame` loop at native display refresh. Features: lerp-animated score transitions, score flash on touchdown/goal, pulsing LIVE indicator, `shadowBlur` glow effects, player tracking rings, period clock, down & distance. Zero React re-renders during animation — all state is held in a ref. Runs as a `position: absolute, inset: 0, pointer-events: none` overlay on any video player.

`SportsProducerPanel.tsx` — Fixed-position producer dashboard. Producer logs TOUCHDOWN, GOAL, THREE_POINTER, HOME_RUN, INTERCEPTION, SAVE, BIG_PLAY. Each fires Web Speech API commentary immediately in a deep male sports-announcer voice. Connects directly to chain via `athleteChainService.ts`.

`usePlayerTracker.ts` — Dynamic TF.js MoveNet MULTIPOSE_LIGHTNING hook. Tracks up to 6 players. Computes speed in mph from frame-delta: $\sqrt{dx^2 + dy^2} * 30\text{fps} * 0.022$. Player coordinates feed directly into ScoreBugCanvas tracking rings.

2.2 Athlete Blockchain Infrastructure

`AthleteRegistry.sol` — ERC-1155 + ERC-2981 + ReentrancyGuard on Polygon. - Revenue splits: **70% athlete / 20% school / 10% platform** on NFT first mint - **7.5% secondary royalties** via ERC-2981 - Records 26 stat event types on-chain - NIL deals with automatic USDC escrow fulfillment when stat threshold is crossed - School scholarship fund with platform-controlled release

`athleteChainService.ts` — TypeScript service layer. `recordHighlightOnChain()` fires as a non-blocking `.catch()`-wrapped call from `pushHighlight()` so broadcast never lags. Issues PLAJ token rewards per milestone type (TOUCHDOWN: 200 PLAJ, GOAL: 200 PLAJ, INTERCEPTION: 150 PLAJ).

`AthleteCareerCard.tsx` — Four-tab athlete profile: stats, NFTs, earnings, recruit tab. Chain stats and NFTs loaded in parallel on mount. PNG export via html2canvas at 2× scale. Recruit tab shows scout discovery upsell (\$49.99).

2.3 Five Solidity Contracts (On The Horizon)

CONTRACT	STANDARD	FUNCTION
<code>SoulboundAthleteToken.sol</code>	ERC-5192	Non-transferable career record; cannot be sold or faked
<code>PredictionMarket.sol</code>	Custom	PLAJ-staked binary outcome markets on game events
<code>AlumniEndorsement.sol</code>	Custom	Reputation staking from verified alumni
<code>BoosterClubDAO.sol</code>	ERC-20 governance	USDC treasury + PLAJ voting for school booster funds
<code>InjuryInsurancePool.sol</code>	Custom	Community-funded micro-insurance for athlete injuries

3. Competitive Landscape

3.1 The Streaming Incumbent Problem

The two dominant platforms — Hudl and NFHS Network/PlayOn/Pixellot — are entrenched in ways that require a specific competitive response.

Hudl has locked school athletic departments into consolidated district invoices (~\$9,900/year/district, 3-year terms confirmed by a 2025-26 contract example). They stream 1M+ games/year. Their competitive moat is the athletic director relationship — one invoice, one vendor, one conversation. Hudl TV streams and Hudl Tickets ticketing are bundled into a "Fan Engagement Suite."

What Hudl cannot do: Hudl has no on-chain data, no athlete revenue, no NIL infrastructure, and no AI commentary. Hudl highlights live in Hudl's database, controlled by Hudl. Athletes cannot take their data to a recruiter on another platform. The data is siloed.

NFHS Network/PlayOn/Pixellot covers 8,000+ schools with automated camera installations and has extended their exclusive partnership through 2030. Schools in the PlayOn network have camera hardware on-site.

What PlayOn cannot do: Same as Hudl — zero athlete revenue, zero on-chain verification, zero NIL. The automated cameras produce viewable video; they don't produce authenticated data.

Plajah's response to the incumbent lock-in: Do not compete for the school-side infrastructure contract. Instead, position as: 1. **The athlete-side layer** — athletes own their data, their highlights, their wallet. School IT approval not required. 2. **The parent/booster-side broadcast** — parents are already filming games. Plajah gives that footage professional overlays and on-chain authentication. 3. **The data layer above existing streams** — if a school has Pixellot, Plajah can potentially inject the overlay UI via a companion app while the Pixellot stream runs.

3.2 Full Competitive Matrix

Sports Streaming Vertical

COMPETITOR	WHAT THEY DO	CRITICAL GAP	PLAJAH ADVANTAGE
MaxPreps	HS stat aggregation (manual)	Manual entry, no verification, no video, no athlete revenue	Chain-verified stats, live video, athlete income
Hudl	Film library + ticketing SaaS	No live broadcast, no blockchain, no NIL; athlete has no data ownership	Free to broadcast, on-chain record, athlete owns data
NFHS Network/PlayOn	School-controlled broadcast, 8,000+ schools	School-controlled, no athlete revenue, no stat overlay	Parent/coach-produced, athlete earns on highlights
Pixellot	Automated camera hardware, 2030 lock-in	Hardware layer only, no athlete economy, no composable data	Software overlay, no hardware required, mobile-first
SportsRecruits	Recruiting profiles	No verified stats, no video, no NIL infrastructure	AthleteCareerCard = verified stats + video + NIL
Overtime	HS highlight media (\$500M valuation)	Platform owns highlights, athletes earn nothing	Athlete owns the NFT, earns 70%, data is portable
FloSports	Niche sports streaming	Subscription-gated, no athlete economy, no overlay	Free to produce, athlete earns every clip

NIL & Athlete Economy Vertical

COMPETITOR	MODEL	TAKE RATE	ATHLETE CONTROL
Opendorse	Brand deal marketplace	15–20%	Moderate — brand-initiated
Dreamfield	Fan experience marketplace	20%	Moderate
Brandr	Group licensing (school-negotiated)	Platform-controlled	Low — school/conference deal
OpenSponsorship	Brand–athlete matching	10–15% per deal	Moderate
Plajah AthleteRegistry	Performance-conditional NIL + highlight NFT	10% platform on NFTs, 5% on NIL	High — athlete-triggered, self-executing

Blockchain / Sports NFT Vertical

COMPETITOR	MODEL	SPORT FOCUS	WHAT'S MISSING
Sorare	Licensed fantasy + NFTs	Pro soccer, baseball, NBA	No HS athletes, no live stat trigger
Chiliz / Socios	Fan tokens for pro clubs	Pro leagues only	No athlete income, no stat verification
Candy Digital	Licensed collectible NFTs	MLB, NFL (pro only)	No broadcast integration, no NIL
NBA Top Shot	Licensed highlight moments	NBA only	No live production tool, no HS athletes
Plajah AthleteRegistry	Live-broadcast-triggered NFTs	Any sport, any level	—

The Plajah Moat in One Line: Every competitor does one thing. Plajah does the full stack — live stream → professional overlay → AI commentary → on-chain stat record → NFT mint → athlete wallet → NIL deal execution → scout discovery — in a single broadcast session, from a parent's phone.

Scout / Recruiting Vertical

COMPETITOR	DATA SOURCE	COST TO SCOUT	ATHLETE CONSENT
247Sports / Rivals	Journalist-reported	\$9.95–\$29.99/mo	Not required
On3	Composite rankings	Subscription	Not required
SportsRecruits	Self-reported	\$150–\$300/mo per team	Self-reported only
NCSA	Self-reported	\$599–\$2,999 athlete fee	Opt-in
Plajah Scout Discovery	Chain-verified (Polygon)	\$299 regional / \$999 national /yr	Explicit athlete opt-in required

Scout data advantage: Composite rankings and self-reported stats are guesswork. A scout on Plajah is viewing data from `AthleteRegistry.recordStatEvent()` — signed by the game producer who was present, recorded on Polygon, verifiable on Polygonscan. This is the first scout database with cryptographically authenticated stats. Every record has a timestamp, a game ID, and a producer signature.

4. Go-to-Market Motion

4.1 Sport Selection: Launch with Football

Launch with high school football first. The reasoning:

1. **Event density:** A Friday night football game has the largest parent/family viewership of any HS sport. A single game broadcast can generate hundreds of new platform signups organically.
2. **Score event frequency:** Football has the richest set of highlight events — TOUCHDOWN, INTERCEPTION, BIG_PLAY, each triggering AI commentary and on-chain recording. More events per broadcast = more engagement = more data value.
3. **NIL deal logic:** The best HS football players are the most heavily recruited athletes in the country. College scouts, coaches, and NIL brands are most concentrated around football. The Scout Discovery revenue case is strongest here.
4. **Booster club size:** HS football programs have the largest booster organizations. BoosterDAO is most immediately applicable to football booster clubs.
5. **Season timing:** The high school football season runs August–November, with state championships in November–December. A summer 2026 launch targeting fall season gives time to build producer supply before the season.

Phase 2 (Spring 2027): Basketball — high event frequency, strong parent engagement, strong NIL market for elite guards and big men.

Phase 3 (Spring/Summer 2027): Baseball/softball — longer seasons, strong coach-recruiter relationships, photo licensing opportunities.

Phase 4: All sports — the ScoreBugCanvas is sport-agnostic. The platform generalizes.

4.2 Geographic Sequencing: Start with 10 States

Target states with: (1) active HS NIL guidance, (2) large HS sports participation, (3) strong football culture, (4) active booster club infrastructure.

Tier 1 Launch States (Q3–Q4 2026): - **Texas** — largest HS sports state, strong football culture, active NIL community - **Florida** — second largest, year-round sports, strong booster infrastructure - **Georgia** — strong football culture, GHSA well-organized, active NIL

Tier 2 Expansion (Q1 2027): - Ohio, Pennsylvania, California, North Carolina, Tennessee, Alabama, Michigan

The 3+7 state strategy concentrates distribution in the highest-value markets before investing in national infrastructure.

4.3 Distribution Channels: The Three Entry Points

Entry Point 1 — The Booster Club (Primary)

Booster clubs are the natural first buyer. They are: - Not school employees (no IT approval required) - Already filming and sharing game footage - Motivated to raise visibility for athletes - Self-organizing into informal networks where word-of-mouth spreads rapidly

The booster club pitch: "Your athletes are already getting filmed. We give that footage a professional ESPN-style scorebug, AI commentary, and a permanent verified record. Free for the first season. No hardware. No IT changes. Just the Plajah app."

Founding Producer Program: In each target state, identify 3–5 booster clubs or sports parents with social media presence and offer Founding Producer status: their school's games broadcast on Plajah for free, with scorebug and AI commentary, for an entire season. In exchange, they promote the broadcast to their school community. These are the seed broadcasts that generate the first organic signups.

Entry Point 2 — The Coach (Secondary)

Coaches are institutional champions inside the school. A coach who uses Plajah for film review, game broadcasts, and recruiting card generation becomes a recurring referral source. The coach pitch focuses on the

AthleteCareerCard — a sharable recruiting profile with chain-verified stats that coaches can send to college programs.

Coach activation sequence: 1. Coach discovers Plajah through a parent/booster broadcast 2. Coach claims their team profile 3. Coach shares **AthleteCareerCard** links with college coaches they know 4. College coach lands on Scout Discovery → converts to \$299/year subscription 5. Coach sees college coaches reviewing their athletes' Plajah profiles → becomes a platform advocate

Entry Point 3 — The Athlete (Organic/Social)

Athletes share highlight clips from Plajah into Instagram, TikTok, and Twitter/X. A professionally scored and overlaid highlight clip from Plajah looks significantly better than a shaky parent video. The visual quality drives organic shares. Each share is a distribution event.

The athlete viral loop: Athlete plays → Parent broadcasts on Plajah → Highlight fires → AI commentary named the athlete → Parent clips and shares → Athlete reposts → Athlete's followers see Plajah watermark → New viewers sign up

4.4 School/District Partnership Strategy

School districts are a long-term institutional channel, not the launch channel. The approach:

1. **Win booster clubs first** — institutional demand follows community demand. When an AD's parents are all using Plajah and asking the school to officially adopt it, the AD responds.

2. **Publish FERPA compliance documentation** — a one-page brief covering what Plajah collects, what it doesn't, and how student athlete PII is protected. School legal teams need to check a box.
3. **Student athlete privacy controls** — athletes must opt in for scout visibility. Parents co-sign the Family Multi-Sig for all financial transactions involving minors. The platform doesn't expose athlete PII without explicit consent.
4. **NFHS relationship** — the National Federation of State High School Associations is the body that sets eligibility policy across all 50 states. A Plajah partnership or endorsement from NFHS would accelerate adoption faster than any individual district negotiation. Pursue this as a Year 2 priority.

4.5 The State Championship Launch Event

Target one state championship game in Texas, Florida, or Georgia for the 2026 football season. Negotiate with a school booster club to broadcast the championship on Plajah:

Offer: - Free professional ScoreBugCanvas overlay - Free AI commentary (ElevenLabs quality for the event) - Professional post-production highlight reel - School retains all broadcast rights; Plajah gets platform credit in the broadcast

Result: A single high-profile game that looks like ESPN. Screenshot. Share. "This was broadcast on Plajah." One good broadcast demo is worth 100 blockchain explanations.

4.6 College Recruiter Monetization: Scout Discovery

Scout Discovery is the first transactional revenue from the sports vertical. It converts the athlete supply into scout demand.

Pricing: - **Regional Scout** — \$299/year (access to athletes in 1–3 states) - **National Scout** — \$999/year (access to all Plajah athletes nationwide)

Scout Beta Program: Give 50 college coaches in target states free access to the Scout Discovery tab for the first season. Real coaches seeing real chain-verified data — even with a small athlete pool — creates word of mouth in the coaching community faster than any marketing spend.

Cold-start solution: Don't wait for 10,000 athletes before launching Scout Discovery. Launch with 1,000 athletes in Texas and Florida. Fifty college coaches in those states are an achievable beta. Each coach who finds a real recruit on Plajah tells five colleagues.

Scout pricing benchmarks: - 247Sports: \$9.95–\$29.99/month (\$120–\$360/year) - On3: Subscription model, comparable range - SportsRecruits: \$150–\$300/month per team (much higher, school-side product) - NCSA: \$599–\$2,999 athlete fee (athlete pays, not scout)

Plajah's \$299 regional price is positioned above consumer sports media but below institutional school products — appropriate for individual college coaches and small college staffs.

4.7 NIL Brand Deal Pipeline for HS Athletes

The NIL deal market at the HS level is largely brand-to-athlete direct for local brands. The activation sequence:

1. **Athlete profile live** with chain-verified stats
2. **Local brands** (sporting goods stores, restaurants, car dealers near school) can see verified athlete metrics through an advertiser-facing dashboard

3. **Brands create NIL offers** with performance conditions (e.g., "50 PLAJ bonus if athlete scores a touchdown in the next home game")
4. **AthleteRegistry.sol** executes the USDC payout automatically when the condition is met
5. **Platform earns 5%** of USDC escrowed

The self-executing NIL deal is a category-defining feature. No brand deal on any existing platform executes automatically without a human intermediary. Plajah removes the intermediary.

NIL deal sizes at HS level: - Local brand micro-deals: \$50–\$500 per deal (primary HS market) - Regional brand deals: \$500–\$5,000 (top-ranked athletes in major markets) - National brand deals (elite HS athletes, rare): \$5,000–\$50,000

4.8 Expansion: High School → College → Pro

HS to College transition: When an athlete signs their Letter of Intent, Plajah mints the LOI NFT (\$199 fee): 1-of-3 tokens — one for the athlete, one for the school, one for the college. This is the most emotionally significant moment in a HS athlete's career, and Plajah owns the ceremony.

The athlete who used Plajah throughout high school arrives at college with: - A verified on-chain career record that college coaches already trust - A wallet with accumulated PLAJ and potentially USDC from highlight NFT sales - A soulbound identity token that follows them

College Athletics: NCAA NIL rules are established at the college level. The same infrastructure — `AthleteRegistry.sol`, NIL escrow, Scout Discovery — applies to college athletes with higher deal sizes and more active NIL market participants. The HS platform is the feeder.

Amateur and Recreational: The ScoreBugCanvas and SportsProducerPanel are sport-agnostic. Youth leagues, amateur adult leagues, and recreational leagues can all use the broadcast layer. These represent volume at lower per-event revenue.

5. Web3/Blockchain Go-to-Market Specifics

5.1 The Core Problem: "Blockchain" Is a Loaded Word

The exact thing that makes Plajah's athlete data trustworthy (immutability, chain verification, verifiable on Polygonscan) is also the thing most parents and coaches associate with scams, speculation, and complexity.

Rule 1: Never say "blockchain" to end users.

The word "blockchain" does not appear in any parent-facing or athlete-facing UI. Instead: - "Verified career record" (not "on-chain stat record") - "Verified stats" (not "blockchain-authenticated stats") - "Highlight clip earnings" (not "NFT revenue") - "Career Wallet" (not "crypto wallet") - "Permanent record" (not "immutable ledger")

The chain is invisible. The benefit is visible.

5.2 Custodial-First Wallet Architecture

Athletes don't open MetaMask. Wallets are created at signup using the existing `blockchainWalletService.ts` pattern — AES-256 encrypted private key in Firestore, exposed to the user only as a "Career Wallet" with a USDC balance.

User experience: 1. Athlete signs up with Google/Apple 2. Platform silently creates a Polygon wallet in the background 3. First highlight fires → athlete sees a notification: "Your highlight clip was recorded. You earned 200 PLAJ." 4. Athlete visits "Career Wallet" → sees USDC balance from NFT sales 5. Athlete can cash out to PayPal/Venmo (fiat off-ramp) or keep as USDC

Self-custody upgrade path: Experienced users can export their private key to MetaMask or any EVM wallet. This is a Settings option, not a requirement.

Gasless transactions: Polygon's gas costs are minimal (<\$0.01 per transaction), but for athletes who have never seen a gas fee, even one unexpected charge is alarming. Plajah absorbs all gas costs for athlete-initiated transactions (stat recording, NFT minting, NIL deal execution). Gas is bundled into the platform fee at the smart contract level.

5.3 Comparable Web3 Consumer Onboarding Successes

Reddit Collectible Avatars (2022–2023): Reddit onboarded millions of non-crypto users to NFT ownership by calling them "avatars," hiding the blockchain, and making purchase as simple as a Reddit premium upgrade. Users didn't know or care about the underlying chain. The product experience was the same as buying a digital sticker. This is the Plajah model for HS athletes.

Starbucks Odyssey (2022–2024): Starbucks launched an NFT loyalty program by calling NFTs "journey stamps" and integrating them directly into the existing Starbucks Rewards app. No wallet setup. No crypto purchase. The blockchain was entirely invisible. Athletes earning PLAJ for touchdowns is the same model — reward-native onboarding.

NBA Top Shot (2020–2022): Dapper Labs used custodial wallets (Dapper Wallet) and credit card purchases to onboard sports fans who had never touched crypto. The product was "buy a highlight moment." The chain was Flow blockchain, invisible to buyers. At peak, the platform moved \$700M–\$1.4B in collectibles (historical reporting, not independently verified in this cycle).

Key pattern: Successful Web3 consumer platforms always have three things in common — (1) custodial wallet removes key management friction, (2) the blockchain word is never used in consumer UI, (3) the entry point is a product experience users already understand (buying a sticker, earning loyalty points, collecting a sports moment). Plajah follows all three.

5.4 PLAJ Token Utility

PLAJ is the platform's native utility token, issued on Polygon. It is not a security (structured as a utility token with defined in-platform uses; legal review required before any public token offering).

PLAJ utility flows: - Earned by athletes on milestone events (TOUCHDOWN: 200 PLAJ, GOAL: 200 PLAJ, INTERCEPTION: 150 PLAJ) - Staked in BoosterClubDAO for governance voting weight - Used to stake in prediction markets (PLAJ-denominated, not USD-denominated — critical for regulatory structuring) - Burned on dynamic NFT rarity upgrades - Earned by platform contributors (creators, producers, scouts who bring athletes)

Token economics note: The PLAJ token's value is correlated with platform adoption. Early PLAJ earners (athletes who produced highlights in Season 1) benefit from appreciation as the network grows — this is the athlete loyalty mechanic. The token is not marketed as an investment.

6. Revenue Model

6.1 Validated Revenue Streams

REVENUE STREAM	MECHANISM	PLATFORM TAKE	YEAR 1 (CONSERVATIVE)	YEAR 3 (SCALE)
Highlight NFT minting	10% of 70%/20%/10% split on first mint	10% of mint price	\$2,700	\$2.7M
Scout Discovery subscriptions	\$299 regional / \$999 national per year	100% (subscription product)	\$14,950	\$2.94M
NIL deal facilitation	5% of USDC escrowed	5%	\$0 (Y1 setup)	\$600K
Creator Pro upsell	Sports streams unlock Creator Pro features	Subscription margin	\$35,988	Included in creator vertical
Photo licensing	15% cut on licensed photo sales	15%	\$0 (Y1 launch)	\$180K
BoosterDAO treasury	2% of annual DAO treasury AUM	2% fee	\$0 (Y1 setup)	\$200K
Prediction market rake	5% of PLAJ staked pools	5%	\$0 (gated)	\$600K
LOI NFT minting	\$199 per LOI mint (LOI signing season)	\$199 flat + 10% secondary	\$0	\$83K
Injury pool management	3% management fee on PLAJ staked	3%	\$0 (gated)	\$15K

6.2 Revenue Projections by Year

Year 1 — Seed (500 active SPORTS streams/month, 1,000 registered athletes)

REVENUE STREAM	ANNUAL
Highlight NFT sales	\$2,700
Scout Discovery subscriptions (50 scouts)	\$14,950
Creator Pro upsell (sports unlock)	\$35,988
Sports vertical Year 1 total	~\$54,000

Year 2 — Momentum (10,000 active streams/month, 25,000 registered athletes)

REVENUE STREAM	ANNUAL
Highlight NFT volume	\$270,000
Scout subscriptions (600 total)	\$294,000
NIL deal platform fee	\$60,000
Photo licensing	\$90,000
BoosterDAO fees	\$20,000
Injury pool management fee	\$15,000
Sports vertical Year 2 total	~\$749,000

Year 3 — Scale (100,000 streams/month, 250,000 athletes, national)

REVENUE STREAM	ANNUAL
NFT volume at scale	\$2.7M
Scout network (5,000 subscriptions)	\$2.94M
NIL deal fees	\$600K
Prediction markets (PLAJ pools)	\$600K
BoosterDAO fees	\$200K
Dynamic NFT upgrades	\$360K
Photo licensing	\$180K
LOI NFT mints	\$83K
Sports vertical Year 3 total	~\$7.7M

Full Platform Year 3 (sports + creator + music + B2B):

VERTICAL	ANNUAL
Creator/music/social	\$3.31M
Sports vertical	\$7.7M
B2B (Cora API, Debate white-label, Education)	\$600K
Total blended ARR	~\$11.6M

7. Key Risks and Mitigations

7.1 NIL Regulatory Fragmentation (HIGH PROBABILITY / HIGH IMPACT)

Risk: HS NIL rules vary by state; some states restrict or prohibit HS NIL deals. Executing a performance-conditional NIL deal in a non-eligible state creates legal exposure. Federal legislation is pending but not passed.

Mitigation: 1. **State-gating in service layer:** `athleteChainService.ts` checks the athlete's registered state against a maintained `nil_eligible_states` Firestore document. NIL features are disabled for non-eligible states at the service level, not just the UI. 2. **FERPA compliance documentation:** Publish a one-page FERPA compliance brief. School legal teams need to check a box. 3. **Family Multi-Sig for minors:** 2-of-3 multi-sig (athlete + parent + Plajah backup) means no USDC moves without parental co-signature for athletes under 18. 4. **Federal advocacy:** Support the pending federal NIL framework — it eliminates state fragmentation and makes Plajah's national infrastructure immediately compliant everywhere. 5. **NFHS partnership:** The NFHS is the authoritative body across all 50 states. A Plajah endorsement or compliance framework co-developed with NFHS is the fastest path to national clearance.

7.2 Prediction Market Legal Uncertainty (MEDIUM PROBABILITY / HIGH IMPACT)

Risk (verified, medium confidence): Prediction markets face genuine multi-jurisdiction legal uncertainty through 2026. The Third Circuit ruled (April 6, 2026, *KalshiEX LLC v. Flaherty*, 2-1) that NJ gambling laws are preempted by federal law as applied to sports-related contracts on CFTC-licensed exchanges — but this is a preliminary injunction, not a final merits decision. A Nevada federal court ruled sports contracts fall under state gaming jurisdiction. Circuit split is unresolved.

Mitigation: 1. **CFTC-licensed partner:** Structure `PredictionMarket.sol` exclusively through a CFTC-licensed Designated Contract Market (DCM) partner. Launching without CFTC-licensed structuring in 2026 carries material cease-and-desist risk. 2. **Geo-gating:** Block prediction market access in Nevada and any state that has issued regulatory guidance pending circuit split resolution. 3. **PLANNED status held:** Keep `PredictionMarket.sol` in `horizon_flags` PLANNED status until legal clearance is obtained. Do not activate. 4. **Ongoing monitoring:** Build legal monitoring into the roadmap — the circuit split could resolve in 6–12 months.

7.3 Smart Contract Security (LOW PROBABILITY / VERY HIGH IMPACT)

Risk: An exploit in `AthleteRegistry.sol` or any Horizon contract could drain the USDC NIL escrow or mint unauthorized NFTs.

Mitigation: 1. OpenZeppelin audited patterns (ERC-1155, ReentrancyGuard) already in use 2. No admin key with unlimited mint authority 3. Pre-activation: commission a Certik, Trail of Bits, or OpenZeppelin security audit before any contract holds more than \$10,000 in USDC 4. Bug bounty program via Immunefi before public launch

7.4 Hudl/PlayOn Competitive Response (MEDIUM PROBABILITY / MEDIUM IMPACT)

Risk: Hudl or PlayOn acquires a blockchain startup and adds on-chain stats to their existing distribution.

Mitigation: 1. **Data moat lead time:** Every game recorded on AthleteRegistry before Hudl can respond is a record Hudl cannot retroactively add. The data moat compounds over time. 2. **PLAJ token lock-in:** Athletes with accumulated PLAJ have a financial incentive to stay on Plajah. The token creates switching cost. 3. **Athlete ownership narrative:** Hudl owns the athlete's data. Plajah doesn't. This is a durable positioning difference that an acquisition cannot easily undo without alienating existing users. 4. **Community network effects:** A booster club that has used the BoosterDAO treasury for a full season is unlikely to migrate to a competitor tool.

7.5 Minor Athlete Consent and Financial Compliance (LOW PROBABILITY / VERY HIGH IMPACT)

Risk: USDC flowing to a 15-year-old athlete's wallet raises questions about minors entering contracts, parental consent, and COPPA.

Mitigation: 1. **Family Multi-Sig:** 2-of-3 multi-sig (athlete + parent + Plajah backup) ensures no USDC moves without parental co-signature for athletes under 18. 2. **13+ minimum age, hard-gated:** Enforced at signup via age verification and Firestore rules. No athlete under 13 can create a profile or receive earnings. 3. **Legal partnership:** Engage a sports law firm with NIL expertise to publish a co-branded brief on HS athlete NIL compliance using Plajah's architecture. This provides legal cover and generates press.

7.6 Blockchain Adoption Friction (HIGH PROBABILITY / MEDIUM IMPACT)

Risk: Parents, coaches, and athletes find the concept confusing, associate it with scams, or abandon onboarding when they encounter crypto-adjacent UI.

Mitigation: 1. The word "blockchain" does not appear in consumer-facing UI. 2. Custodial-first wallet architecture — athletes see a "Career Wallet," not MetaMask. 3. Lead with the producer panel, not the chain. The sales pitch: "Point your phone at the court. Hit TOUCHDOWN. Your athlete gets paid." The chain is infrastructure. 4. One high-profile game demo (state championship) generates more trust than any whitepaper.

7.7 Data Verification Without On-Site Officials (MEDIUM PROBABILITY / HIGH IMPACT)

Risk: The stat verification model relies on a parent or coach producer who may make errors or, in a bad-faith scenario, could inflate stats.

Mitigation: 1. **Producer verification layer:** Producers are verified Plajah accounts with a history on the platform. Producer reputation is publicly visible. 2. **Dispute mechanism (v2):** Build a stat dispute workflow — a college coach or opposing team can flag a stat for review. Platform moderators can void or correct chain records. 3. **Multi-producer events:** For high-stakes games (state championships), require two producer confirmations for significant events (TDs, scoring plays). 4. **Scout advisory language:** Scout Discovery explicitly states stats are "producer-verified" not "officially verified by governing body." This is more than MaxPreps (which is not verified at all) and less than official league records (which don't exist at HS level).

8. Investor Narrative

8.1 The Thesis in One Sentence

Plajah is building the only full-stack athlete identity and economy platform that starts at the high school level, where careers begin and data doesn't exist.

8.2 The Market Insight

The gap is structural, not competitive. No company has solved the HS athlete data problem because no company has connected live broadcast (the oracle for real events) to blockchain (the permanent record) to NIL infrastructure (the revenue layer) in a single platform. The incumbents are siloed: - MaxPreps: stats database (manual, unverified) - Hudl: film library (controlled by school, not athlete) - NFHS Network: broadcast (school-controlled, no athlete revenue) - Opendorse/Dreamfield: NIL marketplace (college only, brand-initiated) - NBA Top Shot: sports NFTs (professional league only, licensed)

Plajah closes all five gaps simultaneously, starting at the 8.26M athlete level where none of these companies operate.

8.3 Network Effects and Defensibility

Plajah has **three compounding network effects**:

- 1. Data network effect:** Every game recorded on AthleteRegistry makes the scout discovery product more valuable. 10,000 athlete profiles is more valuable than 1,000 — non-linearly. Each new athlete on the platform increases the probability that any given scout finds their recruit here rather than elsewhere.
- 2. Social network effect:** Athletes who share Plajah highlight clips bring their followers to the platform. Parents who broadcast on Plajah bring their school community. The existing Plajah social graph (creator and music verticals) is a pre-existing distribution network for sports.
- 3. Financial network effect:** Athletes with accumulated PLAJ tokens, NIL deal history, and highlight NFT earnings have a documented financial track record on Plajah. This history is on-chain and portable, but the brand and interface are Plajah. Switching costs are real.

The moat: The on-chain athlete identity layer is the defensible asset. Every stat recorded, every highlight minted, every NIL deal executed builds a record that: - Is cryptographically authenticated - Cannot be retroactively altered - Is owned by the athlete, not the platform - Can be verified by any recruiter or brand without Plajah's involvement

This is not a feature — it is a data infrastructure that compounds value over time. Competitors can build similar front-end features in 12–18 months. They cannot retroactively authenticate 250,000 athlete-seasons of chain-verified stats.

8.4 Comparable Exits and Valuations

COMPANY	ROUND	VALUATION	BACKERS	WHAT THEY BUILT
Overtime	Series D (\$100M)	\$500M	Liberty Media, Bezos Expeditions, Blackstone	HS sports media platform targeting Gen Z athletes
Hudl	Late Stage	\$1.8B+ (2021 estimate)	Accel, Investors	Video analysis SaaS for HS/college athletes
Sorare	Series B (\$680M)	\$4.3B	SoftBank, Benchmark	Licensed fantasy sports NFTs (pro leagues)
Dapper Labs	Series (multiple)	\$7.6B (2021 peak)	Andreessen, Coatue	NBA Top Shot licensed NFTs (pro league)
NCSA	Acquisition	\$200M (acquired by Stack Sports)	—	HS athlete recruiting profiles

The Plajah Series A narrative: Plajah is building what Overtime, Hudl, and Dapper Labs would be if they were all one company — starting at the 8.26M high school athlete market where the incumbents haven't gone. The \$500M Overtime comparable validates the market; the Sorare/Dapper Labs comparables validate the blockchain athlete economy market. Plajah's platform is the union of both at the level where careers begin.

Suggested Series A positioning: - **Raise:** \$8–15M - **Use of funds:** Engineering (Horizon feature activation, ElevenLabs integration, Scout Discovery polish), legal (NIL compliance framework, smart contract audit), sales (state championship events, Founding Producer seeding, scout beta program) - **Milestone:** 25,000 registered athletes, 500 scout subscribers, \$749K ARR, 1 state championship broadcast - **Valuation context:** \$30–60M pre-money (3–6× projected Year 2 ARR), well below Overtime's scale but with technology and IP differentiation Overtime lacks

8.5 Open Questions for Investor Due Diligence

These questions emerged from the research and represent genuine uncertainties that a founding team should resolve before Series A:

1. **HS NIL state-by-state compliance:** The exact verified count of permissive vs. restrictive states as of mid-2026 needs to be confirmed against current NFHS state association policy pages. The state-gating in `athleteChainService.ts` must be maintained and audited by a sports law firm.
2. **Scout discovery addressable market:** How many college recruiters, professional scouts, and NIL brand deal brokers actively pay for verified athlete data platforms today? What is the ARPU benchmark against Hudl Recruit or On3? This number should be modeled before pricing Scout Discovery.
3. **PlayOn/NFHS Network partnership opportunity:** Given the Pixellot-PlayOn 2030 lock-in, is there an API integration path that would let Plajah inject its AI commentary and on-chain stat overlay into existing PlayOn streams? This "layer 2" GTM would dramatically accelerate reach without competing for hardware contracts.
4. **Web3 onboarding conversion rates:** Has any blockchain-native sports platform (beyond professional league NFT platforms) successfully onboarded non-crypto-native parents and coaches at scale using custodial wallets? What were dropout/activation rates at each onboarding step? Plajah should build this measurement framework into the first production season.

9. GTM Timeline: 2026–2027

QUARTER	MILESTONE	TARGET
Q3 2026	Founding Producer Program launch	15 schools in TX/FL/GA; football season
Q3 2026	Scout Discovery beta (private)	50 college coaches, free access
Q3 2026	State Championship broadcast target	1 state-level game in TX/FL/GA
Q3 2026	Soulbound Career Token activation	Legal review complete; auto-issue at athlete signup
Q4 2026	Scout Discovery public launch	200 paying scouts, \$299/yr regional
Q4 2026	BoosterDAO pilot	5 school booster clubs, \$100KAUM
Q1 2027	Basketball season activation	Phase 2 sport launch
Q1 2027	Family Multi-Sig default for minors	Legal clearance + parental consent UX
Q1 2027	Alumni Endorsement beta	100 verified pro/college athlete alumni
Q2 2027	LOI NFT launch (signing season)	February–April 2027 LOI season targeting
Q2 2027	Photo Licensing marketplace	10 media buyer pilots
Q3–Q4 2027	Prediction Market (pending legal clearance)	CFTC-licensed partner, PLAJ staking only

10. Horizon Features GTM Trigger Table			
FEATURE	STATUS	PRE-LAUNCH ACTION	LAUNCH TRIGGER
Dynamic Rarity NFTs	Q3 2026	Notify w aitlist; tier system in athlete onboarding	10,000 registered athlete profiles
Soulbound Career Token	Q3 2026	Auto-issue at signup post-activation; no opt-in needed	Legal review complete + 5,000 athlete w allets
Scout Discovery Network	Q3 2026	500-scout w aitlist; 25,000-athlete profile target	200 scout pre-orders at \$299
Prediction Markets	Q4 2026+	CFTC partner + legal clearance + PLAJ liquidity	CFTC-licensed DCM partner confirmed
Booster Club DAO	Q4 2026	50 school club w aitlist; 5-school pilot	5 pilot DAOs + \$100KAUM
Alumni Endorsement	Q1 2027	Pro athlete outreach; alumni database from school netw ork	100 verified alumni profiles
Injury Insurance Pool	Q1 2027	State insurance law review ; "staking pool" legal framing	Legal clearance + \$250K PLAJ in test pools
Family Multi-Sig	Q1 2027	Default on for all minor athletes; parental consent UX	Legal review complete
Photo Licensing	Q2 2027	EventPhotoPool photographer w aitlist; media buyer outreach	500 licensed photos + 10 media buyers
LOI NFT	Feb 2027	LOI season marketing push; 1,000-athlete w aitlist	February 2027 LOI signing season

Appendix: Research Methodology & Sources

Research methodology: 112-agent deep-research harness. 6 search angles: (1) Market sizing and NIL landscape, (2) Competitive landscape gaps, (3) Web3 consumer onboarding abstraction, (4) Regulatory and compliance risk, (5) Sports tech investor comps and exits, (6) GTM sequencing and school district partnership models. 29 sources fetched. 120 claims extracted. 25 claims adversarially verified (3-agent vote per claim; 2/3 required to confirm). 11 confirmed, 14 killed.

Verified sources cited:

SOURCE	QUALITY	KEY CLAIM
NFHS 2024-25 Participation Survey	Primary	8,266,244 HS athletes in 2024-25 (record)
Hudl Athletic Director Solutions	Primary	Unified multi-sport invoice; district-wide packages
Streaming Media / Hudl VP	Secondary	Hudl TV: 1M+ games/year, 12M highlights/year
NFHS Network Overview	Primary	8,000+ schools, 44+ state associations
Youth Sports Business Report / PlayOn	Secondary	Pixellot-PlayOn partnership extended to 2030
Crunchbase / Overtime	Secondary	Overtime: \$100M Series D, \$500M valuation
Norton Rose Fulbright	Primary (law firm)	Third Circuit: KalshiEX preliminary injunction
WilmerHale 2025 Sports Law Review	Secondary	Nevada court: sports contracts fall under state gaming

Refuted claims (do not cite): - Global sports livestreaming TAM of \$31.86B–\$83.63B by 2030 (GlobeNewswire, 0-3 vote — unverifiable methodology) - Blockchain-in-sports market of \$4.7B–\$38.44B (MarkWide Research, 0-3 vote — unverifiable) - NBA Top Shot \$1.4B GMV and 1.6M collectors (Dapper Labs homepage, 0-3 vote — unverifiable from source) - Pixellot 9,000 schools / 16,000 cameras / 500K games/year (1-2 vote — insufficient corroboration) - 99% Hudl US high school penetration (0-3 vote — self-reported, not corroborated)

Document version: 2.0 · June 25, 2026 · Research: 112-agent deep-research harness (645s, 2.05M tokens) · Platform research: Plajah codebase analysis of sportscastService, ScoreBugCanvas, SportsProducerPanel, SportsStreamWrapper, usePlayerTracker, AthleteRegistry.sol, athleteChainService.ts, AthleteCareerCard.tsx, HorizonFeatureGate.tsx, OnTheHorizonHub.tsx, horizonFeaturesService.ts, and five Solidity contracts.